

Standard Chartered

Q4 miss, change to guidance basis

Maintain Rating: NEUTRAL | PO: 2,000 GBp | Price: 1,816 GBp

Q425: 6% miss to underlying PBT, from lower Markets

Standard Chartered missed underlying PBT consensus by 6% (\$81m) in Q4, with income missing by 1% (\$37m) and cost missing by 4% (\$143m), partially offset by lower impairments (both credit and other impairment - \$117m beat combined). Below the line items were also a \$164m miss to consensus. Distributions were the bright spot, with dividend 48.6c significantly above consensus 34.7c, and buyback \$1.5bn above consensus \$1.4bn. We maintain Neutral on the stock, as Standard Chartered continues to be well-positioned to capture strong trends in Asia Wealth.

Income miss driven by Markets, cost miss on underlying and reported bases

Within the income line, NII was 8% (\$207m) higher than consensus, largely driven by higher HIBOR in the quarter and timing benefit in treasury income. Non interest income was an 11% (\$243m) miss - within this, Wealth was a 2% miss, Banking was in line, while Markets was a 17% (\$131m) miss due to lower episodic income. Cost was the other area of disappointment, with underlying cost 4% higher than expected, driven by a combination of reg changes and value of cash-settled deferred stock awards given higher share prices. Below the line cost was also a \$164m miss, driven by litigation and conduct (including Korea ELS), and other restructuring.

New guidance: Now on reported basis

Management has made a number of changes to reporting basis, most notably moving from underlying to reported. New guidance includes (i) reported income growth yoy to be around the bottom end of 5-7% range (at 5% implies c.\$22bn, c.2% above consensus \$21.5bn), (ii) reported costs broadly flat yoy (i.e. c.\$13.3bn, marginally above consensus c.\$13.2bn), (iii) stat ROTE in 2026 >12% vs consensus 11.7%. Combining the income and cost guidance it looks to imply mid single digit PBT upgrade. We also note that Ventures will no longer be reported separately.

Estimates (Dec) (USD)	2023A	2024A	2025E	2026E	2027E
Net Income (Adjusted - mn)	3,581	4,276	5,310	5,136	5,784
EPS (Adjusted)	1.29	1.68	2.29	2.36	2.81
EPS Change (YoY)	31.7%	30.4%	36.1%	3.3%	18.9%
Dividend / Share	0.27	0.37	0.53	0.52	0.70
Adjusted NAV PS	13.93	15.41	17.57	18.54	20.14
ADR EPS (Adjusted - US\$)	2.58	3.36	4.58	4.73	5.62
ADR Dividend / Shares (US\$)	0.54	0.74	1.06	1.05	1.41
Valuation (Dec)					
P/E	19.01x	14.57x	10.71x	10.37x	8.72x
Price / NAV	1.76x	1.59x	1.39x	1.32x	1.22x
Net Yield	1.10%	1.51%	2.16%	2.14%	2.87%

24 February 2026

Equity

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Stock Data

Price (Common / ADR)	1,816 GBp / 50.87 USD
Price Objective	2,000 GBp / 53.60 USD
Date Established	22-Jan-2026 / 22-Jan-2026
Investment Opinion	B-2-7 / B-2-7
52-Week Range	872.80 GBp-1,924 GBp
Market Value (mn)	40,976 GBp
Shares Outstanding (mn)	2,257.0 / 1,128.5
Average Daily Value (mn)	79.56 USD
Free Float	100.0%
BofA Ticker / Exchange	SCBFF / LSE
BofA Ticker / Exchange	SCBFY / OTU
Bloomberg / Reuters	STAN LN / STAN.L
ROE (2025E)	10.4%
Net Dbt to Eqty (Dec-2024A)	NA

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Refer to important disclosures on page 7 to 10. Analyst Certification on page 4. Price Objective Basis/Risk on page 4.

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iQprofileSM Standard Chartered

Key Income Statement Data (Dec)	2023A	2024A	2025E	2026E	2027E
(US\$ Millions)	Other GAAP	Other GAAP	Other GAAP	Other GAAP	Other GAAP
Net Interest Income	10,257	11,096	10,922	11,040	11,091
Net Fee Income	0	0	0	0	0
Securities Gains / (Losses)	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
Other Income	7,121	8,600	9,982	10,391	11,448
Total Non-Interest Income	7,121	8,600	9,982	10,391	11,448
Total Operating Income	17,378	19,696	20,904	21,431	22,539
Operating Expenses	(11,136)	(11,790)	(12,217)	(12,430)	(12,737)
Pre-Provision Profit	6,242	7,906	8,687	9,001	9,802
Provisions Expense	(658)	(1,146)	(845)	(1,068)	(1,097)
Operating Profit	5,584	6,760	7,842	7,933	8,705
Non-Operating Items	(491)	(747)	(680)	(960)	(200)
Pre-Tax Income	5,093	6,013	7,162	6,973	8,505
Net Income to sh/holders	3,017	3,593	4,725	4,386	5,566
Adjusted Cash Earnings	3,581	4,276	5,310	5,136	5,784

Key Balance Sheet Data	2023A	2024A	2025E	2026E	2027E
Total Assets	822,844	849,688	920,196	939,965	958,998
Average Interest Earning Assets	572,520	539,338	551,628	596,766	616,167
Risk Weighted Assets	244,151	247,065	262,684	274,747	283,661
Total Gross Customer Loans	292,145	285,936	290,323	300,355	309,381
Total Customer Deposits	469,418	464,489	527,350	551,486	574,114
Tier 1 Capital	39,806	41,672	43,335	43,605	44,676
Tangible Equity	38,231	38,597	40,754	40,677	41,863
Common Shareholders' Equity	44,445	44,388	46,899	47,092	48,475

Key Metrics	2023A	2024A	2025E	2026E	2027E
Net Interest Margin	1.79%	2.06%	1.98%	1.85%	1.80%
Tier 1 Ratio	16.3%	16.9%	16.5%	15.9%	15.7%
Effective Tax Rate	32.0%	32.8%	26.0%	28.5%	27.5%
Loan / Assets Ratio	34.9%	33.1%	31.0%	31.4%	31.7%
Loan / Deposit Ratio	61.1%	60.5%	54.1%	53.6%	53.0%
Oper Leverage (Inc Growth - Cost Growth)	3.27%	7.47%	2.51%	0.78%	2.70%
Gearing (Assets / Equity)	18.5x	19.1x	19.6x	20.0x	19.8x
Tangible Equity / Assets	4.65%	4.54%	4.43%	4.33%	4.37%
Tangible Equity / RWAs	15.7%	15.6%	15.5%	14.8%	14.8%

Business Performance	2023A	2024A	2025E	2026E	2027E
Revenue Growth	10.3%	13.3%	6.13%	2.52%	5.17%
Operating Expense Growth	6.98%	5.87%	3.63%	1.74%	2.48%
Provisions Expense Growth	-24.8%	74.2%	-26.3%	26.4%	2.68%
Operating Revenue / Average Assets	0.68%	0.81%	0.89%	0.85%	0.92%
Operating Expenses / Average Assets	-1.36%	-1.41%	-1.38%	-1.34%	-1.34%
Pre-Provision ROA	0.76%	0.95%	0.98%	0.97%	1.03%
ROA	0.37%	0.43%	0.53%	0.47%	0.59%
Pre-Provision ROE	14.3%	17.8%	19.0%	19.2%	20.5%
ROE	6.89%	8.09%	10.4%	9.33%	11.6%
RoTE	9.87%	11.6%	13.9%	13.1%	14.5%
RoRWAs	1.47%	1.74%	2.08%	1.91%	2.07%
Dividend Payout Ratio	20.9%	22.0%	23.1%	22.2%	25.0%
Efficiency Ratio (Cost / Income Ratio)	64.1%	59.9%	58.4%	58.0%	56.5%

Quality of Earnings	2023A	2024A	2025E	2026E	2027E
Total Non-Interest Inc / Operating Inc	41.0%	43.7%	47.8%	48.5%	50.8%
Market-Related Revenue / Total Revenues	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%
Provisioning Burden as % of PPP	10.5%	14.5%	9.73%	11.9%	11.2%
NPLs plus Foreclosed Real Estate / Loans	2.52%	2.21%	2.21%	2.21%	2.20%
Loan Loss Reserves / NPLs	71.5%	79.1%	77.9%	75.3%	73.1%
Loan Loss Reserves / Total Loans	1.80%	1.74%	1.72%	1.66%	1.61%
Provisions Expense / Average Loans	0.22%	0.40%	0.30%	0.37%	0.37%

Company Sector

Banks-Multinational/Universal

Company Description

Standard Chartered is headquartered in London, but its major operations are in Asia and Africa, with a diverse footprint within these continents. Standard Chartered has three main divisions, including Wealth and Retail Banking, Corporate and Institutional Banking, and Ventures. The shares are listed in both London and Hong Kong in a dual primary listing.

Investment Rationale

We rate Standard Chartered Neutral. We expect Wealth growth to remain strong, and management has been successful in terms of creating differentiated products that are highly valued by their target customers. There is potential downside on NII in a falling US rate environment. We also see downside risk to cost, particularly below the line. Shares are not expensive, but also not obviously cheap versus the sector.

Stock Data

Shares / ADR	2.00
Price to Book Value	1.2x

Quarterly Earnings Estimates

	2024	2025
Q1	0.55A	0.64A
Q2	0.46A	0.77A
Q3	0.40A	0.54A
Q4	0.30A	0.40E



Actual versus consensus

Exhibit 1: STAN Q425 vs consensus

Underlying PBT was c.6% miss to consensus, largely driven by higher costs

	1Q24 Actual	2Q24 Actual	3Q24 Actual	4Q24 Actual	1Q25 Actual	2Q25 Actual	3Q25 Actual	Actual	4Q25 Cons	BofA	Cons	4Q24	3Q25
Profit & loss													
Net interest income	2,656	2,694	2,769	2,977	2,796	2,703	2,737	2,949	2,742	2,686	8%	-1%	8%
Non interest income	2,496	2,112	2,135	1,857	2,594	2,806	2,410	1,899	2,142	2,172	-11%	2%	-21%
Operating income	5,152	4,806	4,904	4,834	5,390	5,509	5,147	4,848	4,884	4,858	-1%	0%	-6%
Operating expenses	(2,786)	(2,887)	(2,840)	(3,277)	(2,915)	(3,050)	(2,953)	(3,429)	(3,286)	(3,299)	4%	5%	16%
Credit impairment	(176)	(73)	(178)	(130)	(219)	(117)	(195)	(145)	(228)	(239)	-36%	12%	-26%
Other impairment	(60)	(83)	(92)	(353)	(6)	(3)	(20)	(13)	(47)	(29)	-72%	-96%	-35%
Associates & JVs	(1)	65	13	(27)	27	64	6	(26)	(9)	(7)	189%	-4%	-533%
Underlying profit before tax	2,129	1,828	1,807	1,047	2,277	2,403	1,985	1,235	1,314	1,284	-6%	18%	-38%
Restructuring charges	(55)	(95)	(91)	(200)	(170)	(123)	(219)	(421)	(257)	(254)	-	-	-
DVA	(48)	22	5	(3)						0	-	-	-
Other	(112)	(177)	1	(44)	(4)					0	-	-	-
Statutory profit before tax	1,914	1,578	1,722	800	2,103	2,280	1,766	814	1,057	1,030	-23%	2%	-54%
Key metrics													
Underlying ROTE	15.2%	12.9%	10.8%	8.1%	16.4%	19.7%	13.4%	9.60%	8.5%	7.8%	1.10%	1.50%	-3.80%
CET1 ratio	13.6%	14.6%	14.2%	14.2%	13.8%	14.3%	14.2%	14.1%	14.1%	14.0%	0.0%	-0.10%	-0.10%
RWA (\$bn)	252,116	241,926	248,900	247,065	253,596	259,700	258,400	258,000	260,900	262,684	-1%	4%	0%
Net customer loans	283,403	275,896	287,300	281,032	281,788	286,700	285,100	286,800	288,100	285,127	0%	2%	1%
Loan loss rate	0.25%	0.11%	0.21%	0.19%	0.25%	0.12%	0.24%	0.20%	0.32%	0.33%	-0.12%	0.02%	-0.04%
TNAVPS	13.90	14.44	15.09	15.41	15.62	16.80	16.84	17.30	17.35	17.57	0%	12%	3%
Dividend	0.00	9.00		28.00		12.30		48.60	34.70	40.62			
Buybacks	0	1,500		1,500		1,300		1,500	1,390	1,500			

Source: Company consensus, BofA Global Research estimates

BofA GLOBAL RESEARCH

Price objective basis & risk

Standard Chartered (SCBFF / SCBFY)

Our primary valuation methodology is a Gordon Growth Model based on our 2027e forecast, to which we add the present value of expected dividends. With a 11% cost of equity assumption, this suggests a price to book multiple of 1.5x, reducing to 1.3x when discounted to a year from now at our cost of equity. Applying this to 2026E tangible book value of 1,854c gives a value of 2,456c pre capital return. To this we add the dividends we forecast through to 2027E (also discounted), and adjust for excess capital to the bottom end of management guidance. Using this valuation approach, we arrive at a price objective of 2,000p (53.60 USD).

The upside risks to our PO are: 1. US rates stay higher for longer, terminal rate higher than expected, 2. further stimulus from the Chinese government, 3. Emerging Asia/ Hong Kong loan growth recovers faster than expected.

The downside risks to our PO are: 1. Loan growth remains subdued for longer, 2. Wealth Management flows slow as competition intensifies in the market, 3. Global trade flows reduce more than expected with higher tariffs.

Analyst Certification

I, Perlie Mong, hereby certify that the views expressed in this research report accurately reflect my personal views about the subject securities and issuers. I also certify that no part of my compensation was, is, or will be, directly or indirectly, related to the specific recommendations or view expressed in this research report.

Special Disclosures

BofA Securities is currently acting as exclusive financial advisor to Polestar Automotive Holding UK PLC in connection with its proposed equity investment by Sumitomo Mitsui Banking Corporation and Standard Chartered Bank, which was announced on February 2, 2026.

EMEA - Banks Coverage Cluster

Investment rating	Company	BofA Ticker	Bloomberg symbol	Analyst
BUY				
	ABN AMRO	ABMRF	ABN NA	Tarik El Mejjad
	Alpha Bank	ALBKF	ALPHA GA	Ilija Novosselsky
	Banco Bilbao Vizcaya Argentaria	BBVA	BBVA US	Antonio Reale
	Bank of Ireland	XBOIF	BIRG ID	Perlie Mong
	Barclays PLC	BCLYF	BARC LN	Perlie Mong
	Barclays PLC	BCS	BCS US	Perlie Mong
	BBVA	BBVXF	BBVA SQ	Antonio Reale
	BNP Paribas	BNPQF	BNP FP	Tarik El Mejjad
	BNP Paribas	BNPQY	BNPQY US	Tarik El Mejjad
	CaixaBank	CIXPF	CABK SQ	Antonio Reale
	Danske Bank	DNSKF	DANSKE DC	Tarik El Mejjad
	Deutsche Bank	DB	DB US	Tarik El Mejjad
	Deutsche Bank	XDUSF	DBK GY	Tarik El Mejjad
	Eurobank	EGFEF	EUROB GA	Ilija Novosselsky
	HSBC -A	HSBC	HSBC US	Perlie Mong
	HSBC Holdings PLC	HBCYF	HSBA LN	Perlie Mong
	KBC Group	KBCSF	KBC BB	Tarik El Mejjad
	KBC Group	KBCSY	KBCSY US	Tarik El Mejjad
	Monte dei Paschi	BMDPF	BMPS IM	Antonio Reale
	Natwest Group	NWG	NWG US	Perlie Mong
	NatWest Group	RBSPF	NWG LN	Perlie Mong
	Piraeus Financial Holdings	BPIRF	TPEIR GA	Ilija Novosselsky
	Societe Generale	SCGLF	GLE FP	Tarik El Mejjad

EMEA - Banks Coverage Cluster

Investment rating	Company	BofA Ticker	Bloomberg symbol	Analyst
	Societe Generale	SCGLY	SCGLY US	Tarik El Mejjad
	UBS	XUHF	UBSG SW	Antonio Reale
	UBS	UBS	UBS US	Antonio Reale
	Unicredit	UNCF	UCG IM	Antonio Reale
	Unicredit	UNCR	UNCR US	Antonio Reale

NEUTRAL

	Allied Irish Banks	AIBR	AIBG ID	Perlie Mong
	Banco BPM	BNCZ	BAMI IM	Antonio Reale
	Banco Sabadell	BNSF	SAB SQ	Antonio Reale
	Commerzbank	CRZF	CBK GY	Tarik El Mejjad
	Credit Agricole	CRAR	ACA FP	Tarik El Mejjad
	DNB	DNBF	DNB NO	Tarik El Mejjad
	DNB	DNBY	DNBY US	Tarik El Mejjad
	ING Groep NV	ING	ING US	Tarik El Mejjad
	ING Groep NV	INGV	INGA NA	Tarik El Mejjad
	Intesa Sanpaolo	IITS	ISP IM	Antonio Reale
	Intesa Sanpaolo	ISNP	ISNP US	Antonio Reale
	Lloyds Banking Group	LLDT	LLOY LN	Perlie Mong
	Lloyds Banking Group	LYG	LYG US	Perlie Mong
	National Bank of Greece	XNBG	ETE GA	Ilija Novosselsky
	Nordea	NBNK	NDA FH	Tarik El Mejjad
	Nordea	XSAB	NDA SS	Tarik El Mejjad
	Nordea	NRDB	NRDB US	Tarik El Mejjad
	Santander	SAN	SAN US	Antonio Reale
	Santander	BCDR	SAN SQ	Antonio Reale
	Standard Chartered	SCBF	STAN LN	Perlie Mong
	Standard Chartered	SCBF	SCBF US	Perlie Mong
	Unicaja	UNJC	UNI SM	Antonio Reale

UNDERPERFORM

	Bankinter	BKIM	BKT SQ	Antonio Reale
	Handelsbanken	SVNL	SHBA SS	Tarik El Mejjad
	Poste Italiane	PITAF	PST IM	Antonio Reale
	SEB	SVKE	SEBA SS	Tarik El Mejjad
	Svenska Handelsbanke	SVNL	SVNL US	Tarik El Mejjad
	Swedbank	SWDB	SWEDA SS	Tarik El Mejjad
	Swedbank	SWDB	SWDB US	Tarik El Mejjad

RVW

	BFF Banking Group	XBBZ	BFF IM	Antonio Reale
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iQmethodSM Measures Definitions

Business Performance

Return On Capital Employed

Return On Equity

Operating Margin

Earnings Growth

Free Cash Flow

Numerator

NOPAT = (EBIT + Interest Income) × (1 – Tax Rate) + Goodwill Amortization

Net Income

Operating Profit

Expected 5 Year CAGR From Latest Actual

Cash Flow From Operations – Total Capex

Denominator

Total Assets – Current Liabilities + ST Debt + Accumulated Goodwill

Amortization

Shareholders' Equity

Sales

N/A

N/A

Quality of Earnings

Cash Realization Ratio

Asset Replacement Ratio

Tax Rate

Net Debt-To-Equity Ratio

Interest Cover

Numerator

Cash Flow From Operations

Capex

Tax Charge

Net Debt = Total Debt – Cash & Equivalents

EBIT

Denominator

Net Income

Depreciation

Pre-Tax Income

Total Equity

Interest Expense

Valuation Toolkit

Price / Earnings Ratio

Price / Book Value

Dividend Yield

Free Cash Flow Yield

Enterprise Value / Sales

Numerator

Current Share Price

Current Share Price

Annualised Declared Cash Dividend

Cash Flow From Operations – Total Capex

EV = Current Share Price × Current Shares + Minority Equity + Net Debt +

Other LT Liabilities

Enterprise Value

Denominator

Diluted Earnings Per Share (Basis As Specified)

Shareholders' Equity / Current Basic Shares

Current Share Price

Market Cap = Current Share Price × Current Basic Shares

Sales

Basic EBIT + Depreciation + Amortization

iQmethodSM is the set of BofA Global Research standard measures that serve to maintain global consistency under three broad headings: Business Performance, Quality of Earnings, and valuations. The key features of iQmethod are: A consistently structured, detailed, and transparent methodology. Guidelines to maximize the effectiveness of the comparative valuation process, and to identify some common pitfalls.

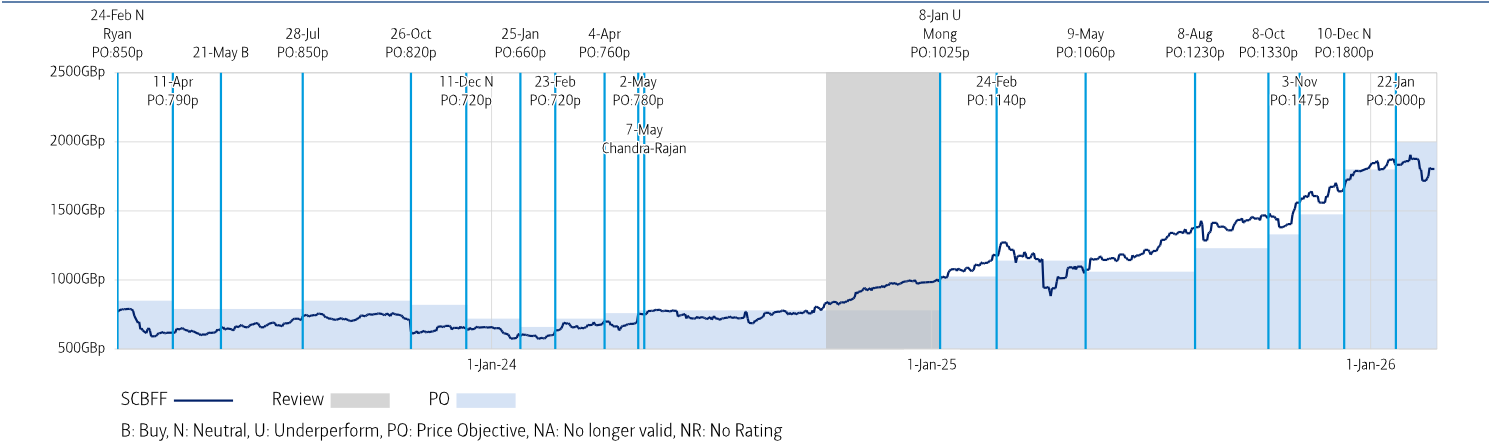
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Disclosures

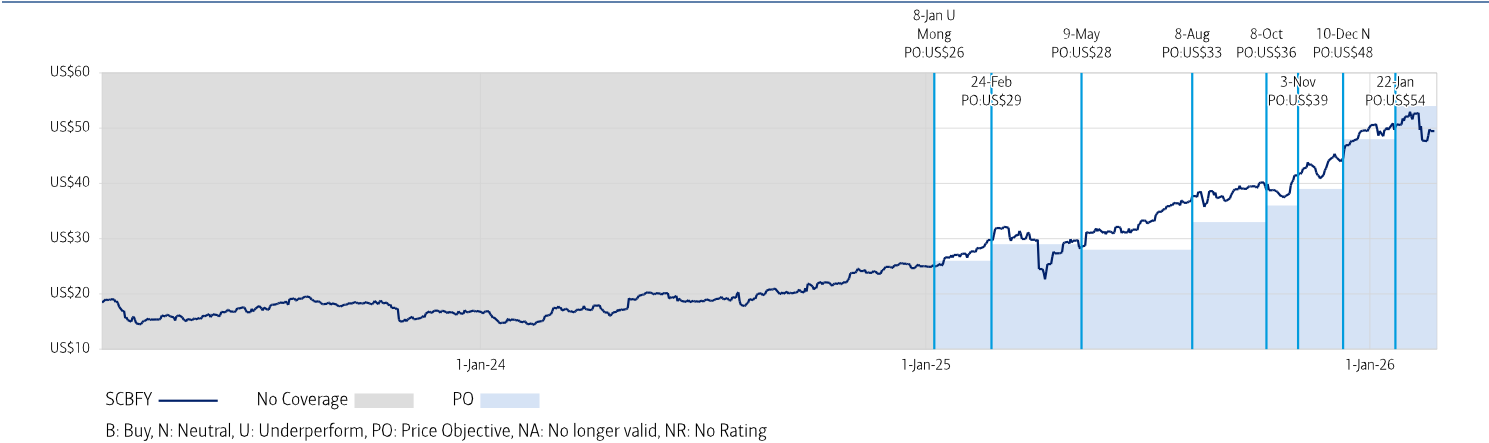
Important Disclosures

Standard Chartered (SCBFF) Price Chart



The Investment Opinion System is contained at the end of the report under the heading "Fundamental Equity Opinion Key". Dark grey shading indicates the security is restricted with the opinion suspended. Medium grey shading indicates the security is under review with the opinion withdrawn. Light grey shading indicates the security is not covered. Chart is current as of a date no more than one trading day prior to the date of the report.

Standard Chartered (SCBFY) Price Chart



The Investment Opinion System is contained at the end of the report under the heading "Fundamental Equity Opinion Key". Dark grey shading indicates the security is restricted with the opinion suspended. Medium grey shading indicates the security is under review with the opinion withdrawn. Light grey shading indicates the security is not covered. Chart is current as of a date no more than one trading day prior to the date of the report.

Equity Investment Rating Distribution: Banks Group (as of 31 Dec 2025)

Coverage Universe	Count	Percent	Inv. Banking Relationships ^{R1}	Count	Percent
Buy	113	54.07%	Buy	90	79.65%
Hold	55	26.32%	Hold	44	80.00%
Sell	41	19.62%	Sell	33	80.49%

Equity Investment Rating Distribution: Global Group (as of 31 Dec 2025)

Coverage Universe	Count	Percent	Inv. Banking Relationships ^{R1}	Count	Percent
Buy	1869	53.99%	Buy	1069	57.20%
Hold	834	24.09%	Hold	481	57.67%
Sell	759	21.92%	Sell	383	50.46%

^{R1} Issuers that were investment banking clients of BofA Securities or one of its affiliates within the past 12 months. For purposes of this Investment Rating Distribution, the coverage universe includes only stocks. A stock rated Neutral is included as a Hold, and a stock rated Underperform is included as a Sell.



FUNDAMENTAL EQUITY OPINION KEY: Opinions include a Volatility Risk Rating, an Investment Rating and an Income Rating. **VOLATILITY RISK RATINGS**, indicators of potential price fluctuation, are: A - Low, B - Medium and C - High. **INVESTMENT RATINGS** reflect the analyst's assessment of both a stock's absolute total return potential as well as its attractiveness for investment relative to other stocks within its Coverage Cluster (defined below). Our investment ratings are: 1 - Buy stocks are expected to have a total return of at least 10% and are the most attractive stocks in the coverage cluster; 2 - Neutral stocks are expected to remain flat or increase in value and are less attractive than Buy rated stocks and 3 - Underperform stocks are the least attractive stocks in a coverage cluster. An investment rating of 6 (No Rating) indicates that a stock is no longer trading on the basis of fundamentals. Analysts assign investment ratings considering, among other things, the 0-12 month total return expectation for a stock and the firm's guidelines for ratings dispersions (shown in the table below). The current price objective for a stock should be referenced to better understand the total return expectation at any given time. The price objective reflects the analyst's view of the potential price appreciation (depreciation).

Investment rating	Total return expectation (within 12-month period of date of initial rating)	Ratings dispersion guidelines for coverage cluster ^{R2}
Buy	≥ 10%	≤ 70%
Neutral	≥ 0%	≤ 30%
Underperform	N/A	≥ 20%

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